I hope the parallels between Razor Pages and web APIs are clear. The majority of the behavior is identical; only the response varies. Everything from when the request arrives to the interaction with the application model is similar between the paradigms.

Most of the differences between Razor Pages and web APIs have less to do with the way the framework works under the hood and are instead related to how the different paradigms are used. For example, in the next section you'll learn how the routing constructs you learned about in chapters 6 and 15 are used with web APIs, using attribute routing.

20.3 Attribute routing: Linking action methods to URLs

In this section you'll learn about attribute routing: the mechanism for associating web API controller actions with a given route template. You'll see how to associate controller actions with specific HTTP verbs like `GET` and `POST` and how to avoid duplication in your templates.

We covered route templates in depth in chapter 6 in the context of minimal APIs, and again in chapter 14 with Razor Pages, and you'll be pleased to know that you use exactly the same route templates with API controllers. The only difference is how you specify the templates. With Razor Pages you use the `@page` directive, and with minimal APIs you use `MapGet()` or `MapPost()`, whereas with API controllers you use routing attributes.

NOTE All three paradigms use *explicit routing* under the hood. The alternative, *conventional* routing, is typically used with traditional MVC controllers and views, as described in chapter 19. As I've mentioned, I don't